

Process description

Last updated: Jun 1, 2026

Outlook Mail Merge - send personalized emails at scale

We can send personalized emails to hundreds of recipients using Microsoft Outlook's Mail Merge feature (without any third-party tools or coding). This is an efficient, scalable solution for teams needing to send customized emails in bulk.

What this process enables:

1. Send **personalized emails** to recipients in bulk
2. Automatically populate fields like **Name, Email, Date, and Custom Message**
3. Use a simple **Excel sheet** to manage your contact list
4. Send emails **directly through your Outlook account**
5. No coding or plugins required

Step-by-step configuration

Step 1: Prepare your contact list in Excel

- Create an Excel spreadsheet as depicted below (no. of columns and field names are customisable)

FirstName	LastName	Email	CustomMessage
John	Doe	john.doe@example.com	Thank you for booking with us!

- Save the file as .xlsx
- Keep the Excel file open while proceeding

Step 2: Create the email template in Microsoft Word

1. Open Microsoft Word
2. Go to **Mailings > Start Mail Merge > E-Mail Messages**
3. Click **Select Recipients > Use an Existing List**, and choose your Excel file
4. Use **Insert Merge Field** to add dynamic placeholders like «FirstName», «CustomMessage»

Example email body:

Hi «FirstName»,

We're excited to see you at the upcoming session!
«CustomMessage»

Warm regards,
Your Team

Step 3: Send the Emails via Outlook

1. In Word, go to **Mailings > Finish & Merge > Send Email Messages**
2. In the pop-up:
 - **To:** Select the email field from your Excel file
 - **Subject Line:** e.g., "Welcome to Clarivate feedback study"
 - **Mail Format:** Choose **HTML** for rich formatting (recommended)
3. Outlook will now send one personalized email per contact from your account

Tips

- Always test with a few rows before sending to the full list
- Ensure Outlook is open and set as your default email client
- Avoid adding too many contacts at once to prevent Outlook from being flagged for spam